

(Printed with the demonstration version of Fade In)

BEYOND THE SCARS
(second draft)

Story by
Temitope Fayomi.

Written by
Obafemi. E. Oniosun.

Copyright (c) 2025

Contact : 09130696617

E.mail : obafemiadebisi19@gmail.com

FADE IN:

1 **INT. RICHARD'S HOUSE - SITTING ROOM - DAY**

1

The settings depicts luxury and affluence. A faint rumbling sound of plate and running tap is heard from a close distance.

The sound of the rumbling is equally matched by the football match commentary showing on the Television -- With **RICHARD (M. 33, tall, dark-skinned, bearded, handsome and can't do without his glasses)** watching as he perches on the couch, tensed and jerkily moving his head.

Moments later, he jumps up, elated.

RICHARD
G-o-o-a-l! Get in there jor!

He begins to run around the sitting room, jubilating -- **STELLA (F. 30, curvy and beautiful)** walks into the sitting room, with a small bowl of popcorn, rolling her eyes, unimpressed.

Richard rushes to her and lifts her -- She smiles.

STELLA
Common! Drop me.

Richard drops her, breathing heavily and smiling at her -- He grabs her waist as they stare into each others face.

RICHARD
You missed that magical moment, my love.

Stella nods in agreement -- She runs her finger slowly on his chest, playfully.

STELLA
Then, make me relive it.

RICHARD
How?

She releases herself from him and begins to run around the room.

STELLA
Catch me, if you can...

Richard shakes his head, with a smile -- They make a runaround chase for few minutes.

BEAT - Richard catches Stella, both panting and laughing.

RICHARD

Even a three year old girl would
catch you in lesser seconds?

STELLA

Guess who is painting, regardless?

RICHARD

(chuckles)

Nobody cares. Let's watch this match
together.

Stella takes a glance at the TV.

STELLA

But you guys are winning. Common,
come and play me.

Stella winks at him. Richard shakes his head, blushing.

STELLA (cont'd)

I have a net. I want you to shoot
your balls in it.

Richard lifts her instantly.

STELLA (cont'd)

Oh my! I love this bad boy.

RICHARD

Time to strike.

They go in.

2 EXT. LOUNGE - DAY

2

The ambience is a serene one as couples and friends are
seated on different tables, chattering and playing games.

Right in a corner, Richard sips his drink, scrolling through
his phone. Stella is on call.

ELIZA V.O

So, when should I expect you in my
house o?

STELLA

(chuckles)

Anytime my man says I'm free.

ELIZA V.O
Hehe! I go love o. Extend my
greetings to him if he's there with
you.

Stella whispers to Richard.

STELLA
(to Richard)
Aunt Eliza says Hi.

Richard gives her a thumbs up.

ELIZA V.O
Make sure you come and visit me soon.
Your babies won't let me rest.

STELLA
Say me hello to them. Tell them big
mummy is coming soon.

ELIZA V.O
Alright then. Take care of yourself.

STELLA
You too. Muah!

Stella drops the call and sips her drink -- She stares at
Richard's drink, with a smirk on her face. Richard notices
and rolls his eyes.

RICHARD
Oh God! Let's not do this today. We
have literally the same drink, same
quantity.

Stella rolls her eyes and sips her drink -- Richard looks
around.

RICHARD (cont'd)
Nothing, I mean no setting is beating
this.

STELLA
What do you mean?

RICHARD
The ambience, the people, the
pleasure you get from this kind of
place. Look around, this place is
filled with innocent people enjoying
lives, especially without their
children.

STELLA
(concerned)
So, if I get your point, you don't
like children around you?

RICHARD
No, babe. Kids are fun but annoying.

Silence ensues -- Richard breaks the ice with a soft
chuckle.

RICHARD (cont'd)
Don't get me wrong. I want kids.

Stella's face lighten up.

STELLA
How many? 6?

RICHARD
What?

Stella laughs.

RICHARD (cont'd)
Half of a dozen? Common. I want
three.

STELLA
Including my twins?

RICHARD
Twins? Coming from a lady who doesn't
like to stressed?

STELLA
Babies are different. They are the
heritage of God. Besides, I want to
carry your babies. Nothing would make
me prouder than growing old with you.

RICHARD
I owe you a kiss if you can tell me
which book of the bible says it...

Stella smiles, get up and kisses Richard.

STELLA
Psalm 127, verse 3.

Richard's jaw drops, stunned. Stella laughs at him.

RICHARD
My mummy just got herself a daughter.

STELLA
My heart just skipped. What if she...

Richard cuts in.

RICHARD
If she likes you? I need you to stay
positive.

Richard grabs her hands. Stella smiles, relieved. They kiss again.

3 INT. RICHARD MOTHER'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - DAY

3

Richard and Stella hold hands as they sit. Stella peep around, forcing smile on her face, restless -- Richard smiles.

RICHARD
Babe. She's human, just like you.
Trust me, she is going to like you.

Stella stares into his eyes and exhales deeply.

RICHARD (cont'd)
Stay calm. I got you.

Footstep approaches, Stella adjusts her sitting position, still restless and anticipating -- **MRS ADEBOWALE (F. 60)** walks in and frowns at the sight of Stella -- She forces a smile as Stella goes on her knees.

STELLA
Good afternoon, ma.

MRS ADEBOWALE
My daughter... get up.

Richard chuckles and prostrate.

RICHARD
Mummy mummy. Good afternoon, ma.

With smile on her, Mrs Adebawale sits.

MRS ADEBOWALE
Both of you should get up.

Richard and Stella obliges.

MRS ADEBOWALE (cont'd)
Richard. How are you?

RICHARD
All good, mum. I am doing fine.

MRS ADEBOWALE
(grin)
Very good. I can see you are here
with your P.A...

Stella swallows hard as Mrs Adebowale glares her.

RICHARD
No mum. This is the lady I have been
telling you about...

MRS ADEBOWALE
Wow, really? My dear. Come here.

Stella goes to meet her. They hug.

STELLA
It's so good to meet you ma.

MRS ADEBOWALE
My pleasure. What is your name again?

SEWA
Stella ma. Stella Fayomi.

MRS ADEBOWALE
I must say, your name is perfect. You
are from which state?

STELLA
I'm from Ogun state.

MRS ADEBOWALE
Interesting. That was where I served
during my service year. Beautiful
state and loving people. Richard...

Richard sits up, smiling.

RICHARD
Yes mum.

MRS ADEBOWALE
You have done a great job. You both
are so lucky to have each other. Your
father will be proud.

Richard and Stella bow slightly.

BOTH
Thank you, ma.

MRS ADEBOWALE
You are always welcome. Let me leave
you to your romance thing.

STELLA
Thank you so much, ma.

Mrs Adebowale gets up, smiles at Stella and walks away --
Stella breathes out, relieved.

RICHARD
(teasing)
Did she bite you?

Stella rushes to Femi and hug him -- They kiss.

STELLA
That was the longest three minutes of
my life.

RICHARD
If I love you, she has to love you
too, unless she has another son
somewhere else.

STELLA
(scoffs)
You are so full of yourself.

RICHARD
That is why you love me.

Richard tickles her, playfully. They kiss.

4 INT. STELLA'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

4

A dimly lit room, with everything in order. Stella lies in
her bed, covered in duvet. She smiles as she thumbs her
phone, blushing. She swipes through her pictures with
Richard -- She chuckles at interval anytime she bumps on any
goofy picture of them.

Few minutes later, she drops the phone on her chest, slowly,
with the smile fading off her face -- She sighs.

STELLA
So, this is love?

Silence lingers for few seconds, then she jumps up, sharply
and sits up in her bed.

STELLA (cont'd)
I don't want to lose this guy. S-t-e-
l-a-a-a-a! He just came out of
nowhere and ticked all my boxes.

She looks at her reading table and smiles at portrait of her and Richard.

STELLA (cont'd)
Wait... it is almost two years we
took that picture and I'm still
crazily in love with him.

She slaps both of her palms on her cheeks, dramatically.

STELLA (cont'd)
For us to be together after a year,
then he is the one. YES! I won... I
won in this game of love...

Her last word trails off as she reminisce about **Scene 3**.

STELLA (cont'd)
(worried)
Something feels wrong about... about
his mum. Wait, did she not like me?

Her eyes furrow, more worried. In a split second, she shrugs.

STELLA (cont'd)
I was nervous. She is nice. I have
won... I have won...

She repeats the line as she rests back in bed.

5 **INT. STELLA'S OFFICE - DAY**

5

The office depicts a typical **HEAD OF HUMAN RESOURCES** office. Stella, dressed in blue suit, works on her laptop. Her focus drifts off the laptop at intervals as she stares blankly, in a thinking and calculating manner.

She pens down couple of things in her jotter at intervals. Few seconds later, knocks on the door.

Without looking up.

STELLA
It is opened.

Door opens, **JENNIFER (F. 26, skinny and barely smiles)** walks in with a gift bag in her hand. She steps closer to her desk -- Stella's gaze is still on her laptop.

JENNIFER
I am so happy for you, ma. Is today
your birthday?

Stella looks up, sharp and expectant.

STELLA
(loud)
What do you mean by that?

Jennifer stretch the gift bag to Stella -- Stella's jaw drops, with an hint of cluelessness in her expression.

JENNIFER
I don't even know. I am just as
clueless as the delivery man and you.
I think the package is for you...

Jennifer drop the bag on the table, wearing a serious look.

STELLA
(annoyed)
What is wrong with you? Do you even
know whose office...

Stella's phone rings -- She sighs as she clenches her fist.

STELLA (cont'd)
Out of my sight right now. Out!

Jennifer turns and strides out. Stella picks the call.

RICHARD V.O
Hey baby.

STELLA
My darling...

RICHARD V.O
You sound stressed. It's barely 1pm.

STELLA
Don't mind me. I still don't know why
this company have refused to hire
another receptionist after the
complaints I have lodged against this
silly one.

RICHARD V.O
(chuckles)
If it's not feeding you, then it
shouldn't affect you in any way.
Don't mind her.

Stella smiles and rest her back in her chair, playing with
the helm of her suit.

STELLA
You are so apt. You always know when
to call in.

RICHARD V.O
I am your man. I know what gets to
you. By the way, did you get my
package?

Stella sits up, drags the gift bag closer to herself.

STELLA
The package is from you?

She begins to check the content.

RICHARD V.O
(chuckles)
Excuse me. Are you expecting this
gift from any other guy?

STELLA
No... no. I am just surprised. This
is so thoughtful of you. Thank you
baby.

RICHARD V.O
Anything for you.

STELLA
(teasingly)
So, how do I reciprocate this... sexy
gesture? It's freaky Friday.

RICHARD V.O
Common baby. It is just a gift. It's
not that deep.

Stella pouts, unsatisfied.

STELLA
So, you don't want me to come over?

RICHARD V.O

Oh? Yeah! Sure. You can come over,
maybe tomorrow.

STELLA

See you by 6pm today. Bye, baby.

Stella hangs up the call and begins to rummage the gift box properly.

6 INT. RICHARD'S HOUSE - BEDROOM - NIGHT

6

Stella and Richard chuckles as they converse in bed --
Stella rests her head on his chest, tracing his chest with
her fingers. Richard pats her arm.

STELLA

(hisses)

You wish. I don't see you finish. I
can't fall for an obvious bait...

Richard sighs.

RICHARD

Really? So, I cannot piss you off you
off anymore?

Stella gets up, trying hard not to laugh.

STELLA

Whatever you have up your sleeves
right now, hold it back.

They both laugh -- Stella rests her head back on his chest.

STELLA (cont'd)

So, tell me, what was the craziest
thing you have done for love?

RICHARD

(sigh)

You see... let the past remain in the
past. I... don't really like them.

STELLA

But I want to know...

RICHARD

And I said don't worry about it.
Focus on me. I am here with you now.

Stella sits up again, arms crossed and furrowed eyes, angry.

RICHARD (cont'd)
(mumbles)
Oh God...

Richard sits up. He tries to touch Stella -- She yanks off his hand.

STELLA
(sharp)
Don't you dare! Don't. You. Dare!

RICHARD
Why do you find it so hard to admit that I hate to focus or speak of my past? I mean... some of them, hmm...

STELLA
(cuts in)
Some are there are what? Too bloody or sexual?

RICHARD
(yells)
No. I don't just want to speak about them. If you think I have anything up my sleeves, why haven't you seen Police raid my house or get ambushed by a random lady?

Stella blinks repeatedly, trying to calm herself down.

RICHARD (cont'd)
There you go! Stop digging for trouble where there is none.

Richard breathes heavily and lay back in bed, facing another direction. Stella sighs, with guilt written all over her face. She slowly gets back in bed and snuggle up with Richard.

STELLA
(mumbles)
I am sorry...

7 INT. RICHARD'S HOUSE - BEDROOM - MIDNIGHT

7

Richard whimpers as his voice is overshadowed by the cries of a lady under torture.

Richard's breathing rate increases, the lady's cries overshadows his voice more and more...

Suddenly, he wakes up, breathing heavily with sweat all over him -- He looks to his side and sees Stella, deep in sleep.

RICHARD
(mumbles)
This... this has to stop.

His heavy breathe lingers as he gets off the bed and head into the toilet.

8 INT. GROCERY STORE - FEW DAYS LATER

8

Regular activities in the grocery store is on, as people chatter indistinctive. Richard pushes the wheel as Stella picks food item from the shelves. She picks up a Semovita pack.

STELLA
This?

Richard looks at Stella's hand and chuckles softly.

RICHARD
Not even a chance. I got my hate for Semo through her.

Stella Shakes her head and smile.

STELLA
Fine. I will check for cleaning items. You stay here and pick her other favorites.

RICHARD
As your lordship pleases ma'am.

Stella smiles and walks away to another direction. Richard's gaze begins to scan all the Food item in sight, while moving past them slowly -- A leg in Slingback heel pokes into the section Richard is... In split second, **TENIOLA (F. 28, curvy, dressed in cooperate)** in her full appearance stares at Richard, with a damp on her face, shocked.

Richard, oblivious and genuinely picking items finally turns. The lock eyes for split second -- Richard startles, with his jaw dropped. Teni makes a jerky head movement with a little smirk on her face, like she just won a battle.

TENIOLA
Small world it is...

Richard swallows hard, tensed.

TENIOLA (cont'd)
Hi, stranger. Or should I say...
murderer?

Richard motions to move close -- Teni recoils, with a smirk.

TENIOLA (cont'd)
(low tone)
Don't you move to me. You Satan!

RICHARD
See... listen to me. I know I screwed
up, in fact, very bad. Just do me a
favor...

Before he lands with his statement, Stella pushes the
shopping wheel into the shot.

STELLA
What favor?

Teni laughs, as if nothing happened. She faces Stella.

TENIOLA
(smile)
Hello...

STELLA
Yes? From where?

Richard stutters as he tries to speak -- Teni cuts in.

TENIOLA
No offense ma'am. Your brother here
just want me to take a picture of
him.

STELLA
Oh! Fine then. Take us together and
please, he is my Fiance, not brother.
We are acting shopping for my mother-
in-law. I guess a picture can't hurt.

TENIOLA
I am so sorry. I did not see that
coming.

Teniola reaches for her phone. Stella moves close to
Richard -- Teniola takes a few shot with her phone.

STELLA
Great. Did we look great?

TENIOLA

Sure. Let me send them to you.

Richard's eyes widen, with his fist clenched, restless.

RICHARD

(shocked)

What?

STELLA

Wait, that is an Iphone, right?

TENIOLA

Yes.

Stella waves her android phone at Teniola.

TENIOLA (cont'd)

Oh! These pictures are really nice. I will really like you to have them.

STELLA

Let me have your number then. I will text you on Whatsapp.

Teniola calls out her number -- Stella input it on her phone. Richard watches, helpless and restless.

TENIOLA

I will be expecting your text.

RICHARD

Thank you. Let's go.

Teniola gives Richard a last look, more of a battle line is drawn. Richard swallows hard and quickly find his way out of Teniola's sight -- Stella follow him. Teniola raises her shoulders, satisfied.

9 INT. RICHARD'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - DAY

9

Richard stares at the T.V screen blankly, uninterested and bothered. Moments after, Stella comes out, all jolly and happy. She holds the a Filer and nail cutter and her phone.

STELLA

Hey babe.

She sits beside him -- Richard keeps to himself.

STELLA (cont'd)
Babe... babe. Come and cut my nails
for me.

No response from Richard -- Stella notices his docility and drops all in her hand.

STELLA (cont'd)
Babe. Is something wrong? You look
pale...

RICHARD
(stutters)
I am... I am okay.

STELLA
No. You are not okay and with all I
have seen, there is more to it. You
are only moody when you are hungry or
your team is losing. Your team is not
even playing, neither are we short of
food stuff. So, talk to me...

Richard smiles, and grabs her hand.

RICHARD
Trust me, I am perfectly fine. I
can't be cheerful all the time...

STELLA
(stunned)
You?

Stella's phone vibrates. She picks it up and check the screen for few seconds.

STELLA (cont'd)
Oh! The lady sent the pictures
already.

Richard clears his throat, restless. Stella looks at him, curious.

STELLA (cont'd)
Babe. Is there something I don't
know?

Silence lingers between them as Stella gazes at Richard, intently.

RICHARD
(stutters)
That lady... errm, let me see those
pictures.

Stella hesitate for a second but hands Richard the phone. Richard stares at the screen, carried away and forgets to comment.

STELLA

Babe!

Richard snaps out.

RICHARD

Oh yes! They look perfect. Send them to me.

Stella frowns as she sits back and begins to file her nails.

10 INT. RICHARD'S MOTHER'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NEXT DAY

10

Richard and Mrs Adebowale converse. The atmosphere is tense. Richard, with his head bowed, tingles his fingers and toes, restless.

Mrs Adebowale, with her chin up and arms crossed, exhales with a stern look on her face.

RICHARD

Mum. What do we do? I am about... about to lose it.

MRS ADEBOWALE

This is a loophole. What do you think we should do?

Richard stares intently at her, confused.

RICHARD

Why would I be here if I could handle it?

MRS ADEBOWALE

(chuckles softly)

So you need my guidance now?

Richard, with falling shoulders, clueless.

MRS ADEBOWALE (cont'd)

Where did you put me when you wanted to get a woman for yourself? Did you not sideline me?

RICHARD

(grunts)

What business... what are you even saying Mum?

MRS ADEBOWALE
Listen. I will advise on you what to
do but you need to know that lady is
not worth it?

RICHARD
I know... she just came out of
nowhere...

MRS ADEBOWALE
Oh you fool! I meant the girl to
brought here the other day.

Richard's eyebrows gather in, shocked.

MRS ADEBOWALE (cont'd)
I don't like her. She is way too
goofy to handle you and your baggage.

Richard chuckles bitterly.

RICHARD
Wow! You don't like this one too? And
suddenly, I have baggage now? Mum, I
came for advice, not insults.

MRS ADEBOWALE
And there you have it. I can't help.
I can't deal with that lady. You are
all I have. She can't handle the
truth...

She sits up and stares at Richard.

MRS ADEBOWALE (cont'd)
Let. Her. Go. I will find a perfect
woman for you.

Richard stares at her, with damp eyes, disappointed.

11 **EXT. RESTAURANT - SAME TIME**

11

Teniola approach the restaurant entrance, thumbing her
phone. Few seconds later, she looks up and sees Stella
coming out of the restaurant -- Her face lights up, happy.

TENIOLA
(teasingly)
It is a lie! Oh my God!

Stella looks up and sees her. She chuckles softly, pleased.

STELLA
Hey! Our photographer...

They approach each other and hug.

TENIOLA
It's so good to see you again.

They disengage.

STELLA
Same here. You come here often?

TENIOLA
(smirk)
Yes. I do. This is my favorite
restaurant. By the way, how is your
fiance?

STELLA
(blushes)
He is perfectly fine.

TENIOLA
That's so great. Oh yes! I texted you
few days ago. You didn't respond.
Hope all is well?

Stella, with her mouth slightly opened.

STELLA
I am so sorry. Don't mind me. Between
work and my man, I have no time for
other stuff.

TENIOLA
(chuckles)
Wow! I envy the level of your
intimacy with him.

STELLA
Aww! Isn't that sweet? He's my best
friend. We know everything about each
other.

Teniola giggles, mockingly.

TENIOLA
Oh great! So, you know about the
mark?

Stella makes a jerky head movement, confused.

STELLA

What mark are you talking... ?

TENIOLA

(cuts in)

Never mind. I am just teasing you. I could be a handful sometimes...

Teniola giggles as she pats Stella's shoulder.

TENIOLA (cont'd)

Don't let me delay you. Remember to respond to my text.

STELLA

Hmm.

Stella, still confused, watch Teniola stride into the restaurant, elegantly.

12 INT. RICHARD'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - AN HOUR LATER

12

Richard sits on the couch. His gaze is on the TV Screen, yet not reacting to what he is seeing, neither are his eyeballs rolling. He is lost in thought.

Few seconds after, door bangs open, LOUD. Richard snaps out of his thought immediately, with his gaze on the opened door -- It's Stella, with her eyes furrowed and breathing heavily, angry.

Richard sits up.

RICHARD

Babe.

With force, Stella slams the door shut and faces Richard, livid.

RICHARD (cont'd)

(stutters)

Babe... hi, sorry. What is wrong?

Stella strides towards Richard -- He gets up as she reaches half way. Every step she takes towards him sends a shivering signal down his body as he blinks rapidly. Stella flings her back to a side.

STELLA

Richard! No. More. Games! You have to answer my question.

Richard motions to touch her -- She recoils, still angry.

RICHARD

Babe... I need you to calm down.
Whatever it is, we can settle it
amicably.

STELLA

(chuckles bitterly)
Amicably ahn? I am done with slow
response. I need your answer right
now. Why do you have that mark on
your shoulder?

Richard's eyes widens, shocked. In a split second, as if
he's been caught, he chuckles softly, hoping to see Stella
smile -- Her angry face remains.

STELLA (cont'd)

Answer me, Richard.

Richard sighs, with a sad look. He sits gently on the
couch -- Stella crosses her arms, still angry.

RICHARD

It was... it was my Dad. Few years
before he passed on. I did a very
silly thing. He finally realized the
truth after sometime, then he dealt
with me, thoroughly and... severely.
Even my mum couldn't rescue me...

Stella's arms drop, with a more relaxed, yet guilty face.

RICHARD (cont'd)

He said I'd show the mark to my kids
and yes, I guess I will...

He looks at Stella, with a faint smile on his face.

RICHARD (cont'd)

I will show it to our kids...

STELLA

(stutters)
Oh my God! What have I done? I am so
sorry... It was that, you know...
Never mind. I am so sorry babe.

Stella goes to sits beside him, petting him.

STELLA (cont'd)

For poking into your past wound.
Forgive me baby.

Stella pecks him. They hug. A soft smirk runs across his face, relieved.

13 INT. RICHARD'S HOUSE - BEDROOM - MIDNIGHT

13

Richard slumbers, backing Stella -- Stella sits up in bed, body covered in duvet and arms crossed, anxious.

She looks at Richard, nods hesitatingly at intervals, doubtful.

She sighs and stare at Richard, as if the answer to her curiosity is written all over him.

Moments after, her phone beeps -- She reaches for it and sees the caller "Teniola"

STELLA
(hesitating)
Wait... what is...?

She picks the call. Teniola speaks with a smirky voice.

TENIOLA V.O
H-e-l-l-o-o-o-o-o!

STELLA
At this time of the night? What's the matter?

TENIOLA V.O
Nothing much. I am fine. How about you?

Stella hesitate for a second, confused.

STELLA
I am... fine. Why are you calling me?

TENIOLA V.O
Relax ma. I just wanted to ask if he has told you about the mark...

Stella grunts, almost losing her patience.

STELLA
(whispers)
Young lady. Be careful. Why are you stressing me? What silly mark are you talking about?

TENIOLA V.O

(chuckles)

I am sure he told you a funny story
and now, you are not sure if you want
to trust the story or not... Well, I
know the story and it's deeper than
what you think...

Stella goes mute, heavily stunned as she shuffles her gaze
between Richard and her phone.

TENIOLA V.O (cont'd)

4pm at B-Lounge tomorrow, if you
really care to know... Bye for now.

Teniola hangs up -- Stella slowly drops the phone, almost
shivering, unsure of her current emotions.

14 INT. RICHARD'S MOTHER'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NEXT MORNING

14

Stella, moody and confused, lost in her thought perches on
the couch. Mrs Adebowale walks into the living room.

MRS ADEBOWALE

Sandra...

Still lost in her thought, Stella keeps mute until Mrs
Adebowale sits.

MRS ADEBOWALE (cont'd)

Sandra...

Stella snaps out of her thought.

STELLA

I am so sorry ma. Good morning, ma.

She goes on her knees.

MRS ADEBOWALE

(cold look)

I thought you wanted me to call
Sandra the third time before you
respond...

STELLA

(chuckles)

No, ma. I was just carried away by my
thought but... who is Sandra ma?

MRS ADEBOWALE
We are just two here. I certainly
can't be calling my own name. You of
course...

STELLA
Oh! My name is Stella ma, not Sandra.

With no remorse or regard on Mrs Adebowale's face -- She
shrugs it off.

MRS ADEBOWALE
How can I be of help to you?

STELLA
(clears her throat)
Yes ma. Richard's been keeping to
himself, which is unusual. I inquired
somethings from him...

Mrs Adebowale cuts in, disgust all over her face. Stella
tries to avoid eye contact with her.

MRS ADEBOWALE
Somethings like what... answer me.

STELLA
(stutters)
Nothing deep, ma. Somethings about
his past.

MRS ADEBOWALE
(chuckles)
You know... for a young and pretty
lady like you, you are way too nosy.

Stella's eyes widen, shocked.

MRS ADEBOWALE (cont'd)
Yes, you are. Why are you frustrating
my son? Do you realize he is the only
one I have? Why are you poking him so
much? Listen to me, if anything
should happen to him, I. will. deal.
with. you. Back off.

Stella watches in shock, lips partly opened -- Mrs Adebowale
yells, furious.

MRS ADEBOWALE (cont'd)
Out of my house! Dirty stinking
thing!

Stella bows repeatedly as she gets up and walk out.

15 **EXT. LOUNGE - 4PM**

15

Lounge activities goes on in the background. Teniola, sitting elegantly with a little smirk on her face, watches Stella gulp down the half full cup of beer -- Stella bangs the cup on the table as soon as she finishes.

TENIOLA

Oops! Easy mama. Why so harsh?

Stella, with narrowed eyes, intoxicated -- She stares at Teniola for few seconds and swallows hard.

STELLA

Tell... tell me everything.

Teniola smiles and adjusts her dress, ready to reveal.

INTER CUT

16 **INT. RICHARD'S MOTHER'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - SAME TIME**

16

Richard paces, angry. Mrs Adebowale sits on the couch, sipping her drink at intervals.

Richard pants as he finally faces his mother, silence for a while **UNTIL...**

RICHARD

(yells)

Mum! How dare you?

MRS ADEBOWALE

How dare you speak to me like that?
Are you sick in the head?

RICHARD

Yes! Yes Mum! You just poked my wound.

MRS ADEBOWALE

(chuckles)

What did I do? I only did my job...

Richard shakes his head, disappointed.

RICHARD

Job? As what? My guardian angel or what?

MRS ADEBOWALE

As your mother, you fool. Are you blind to see that I am on your side?

(MORE)

MRS ADEBOWALE (cont'd)
Must it get too late for you before
you realize that this girl isn't for
you?

Richard clenches his fist and jaw, raging.

RICHARD
But what have I done to deserve this?
I have brought over 5 girls to you in
the last six years. You... you never
approved of any...

Mrs Adebowale cuts in and sits up.

MRS ADEBOWALE
Because they are not worth it. They
just want to run you dry and leave.

Silence ensues. Richard chuckles bitterly as he falls into a
different couch. Mrs Adebowale rests her back.

RICHARD
Is this how I am going to die,
miserably?

MRS ADEBOWALE
Hey! Stop saying that...

RICHARD
(yells)
Then let me pick a woman that I want!
It is my life, not yours!

MRS ADEBOWALE
(yells)
Oh! Now you want to do things your
way and hurt me? What kind of a woman
would settle for a man with terrible
secret like you?

Richard's jaw drops, shocked.

MRS ADEBOWALE (cont'd)
You are lucky I haven't told her the
secret yet. Nonsense.

She picks up her drink and slugs -- Richard watches in
shock, shaking his head slightly.

RICHARD
(mumbles)
This cannot be my Mother...

INTER CUT

17 **EXT. LOUNGE - SAME TIME.**

17

Teniola brings out an handkerchief out of her bag and hand it to Stella, whose eyes are now glassy, as tears rolls down her cheek, crying.

STELLA

This cannot be my Richard.

Teniola scoffs.

TENIOLA

Wipe your tears. It is your Richard. He is really not who you think he is and unless you want to spend the rest of your life with a man that cannot his woman, you should break up with him.

Stella bangs the table, angry -- Teniola flinches, scared.

STELLA

I am done here.

She grabs her phone and staggers up the chair. Teniola smirks.

18 **INT. RICHARD'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT**

18

Richard and Stella's voices ring aloud from a close range.

STELLA O.S

(yells)

I need answers!

RICHARD O.S

I have nothing to say to you.

With force, the door leading to the entrance room opens sharply, Richard storms in, angry. Stella follows him.

RICHARD

Stop projecting your insecurity on me!

Stella look around, confused

STELLA

Insecurities? Me? I am asking you a simple question, Richard. Why are you dodging my question if you truly have no skeleton in your cupboard?

RICHARD
Are you drunk? What has come over
you?

STELLA
(low tone)
Listen, that lady at the grocery
store the other day told me every
single thing that happened...

Stella's voice becomes shaky.

STELLA (cont'd)
(stammers)
How could... could you lie to me? I
have been nothing but plain and
opened to you but here you are,
claiming to be oblivious...

RICHARD
Young lady. Whatever thing you heard
about me, it is left to you to
believe or not... I have nothing to
say to you.

STELLA
(confused)
Am I dreaming? I need help... I need
help!

Stella screams and falls into a couch, still screaming as
she blocks her ears, crying -- Richard flinches, shocked and
clueless.

RICHARD
(stutters)
Babe...

STELLA
(yells)
Get. Out. Of. My. Sight!

Richard rushes in, scared. Stella continue crying and
shivering.

19 INT. RICHARD'S HOUSE - MASTER BEDROOM - NIGHT

19

The bed and floor are littered with tissues -- Stella sleeps
on her back, staring at the ceiling, with tears rolling down
her cheeks.

Knocks on the door...

RICHARD O.S
Babe... Please open the door. I have
no idea of what you've heard but I
can assure you that none of them are
true...

Stella whimper out.

RICHARD O.S (cont'd)
This is just... just devil trying to
ruin what we have. We have to stand
our ground and fight for our love.

Stella cries louder.

RICHARD O.S (cont'd)
I made your favorite. Please, step
out and let's eat and talk.

Stella goes silent, staring intently and lost at the
ceiling, pale and exhausted -- More knocks on the door.

RICHARD O.S (cont'd)
Babe... please talk. I won't leave
unless you talk...

More knocks on the door.

20 INT. STELLA'S OFFICE - NEXT DAY

20

Stella slouches in her, face swollen, sad. She stares
blankly, lost in her thought.

Her table is tidied up, well organized, as if she has not
touch anything so far.

Minutes later, Jennifer comes in with a gift box in her
hand -- She attempts to drop the gift box on the table but
Stella's unresponsiveness catches her attention.

Without saying a word, Jennifer gestures in askance if she
can go with the gift box -- Stella nods slowly in
agreement -- Jennifer puts on a wide grin as she steps out
with the gift box. Stella twirls her chair to another
direction, still sad.

She twirls back, with a serious look. She picks up her phone
and gets up and storms out of her office.

21 INT. RICHARD'S MOTHER'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - DAY

21

Stella perches on the couch, kneels locked and face down, dread in thought. Footsteps approaches, in a slow pace. Mrs Adebowale walks into the sitting room and furrows her eyes at the sight of Stella.

MRS ADEBOWALE

Young lady! What'd you want from me?

Stella jerks up, startled. She stands up as Mrs Adebowale sits, with her face reeking of disdain.

STELLA

Good day, ma.

MRS ADEBOWALE

Miss me with all that greetings. Why are you in my house again? Haven't I warned you not to...

Stella cuts in, with a soft yell.

STELLA

I did not come to fight you, ma. I am here to inquire... about somethings, ma. I believe you would know better.

Mrs Adebowale stares at her, with no emotion on her face.

STELLA (cont'd)

Can I sit, ma?

MRS ADEBOWALE

Are you here to sit or talk?

STELLA

It's... fine, ma. Recently, I met a lady, whom I believe knows one or two things about Richard. We got talking and she told me what really happened... between, everything that she knows about Richard...

MRS ADEBOWALE

So?

STELLA

Ma. Richard has refused to come clean to me. I am obliged to know somethings about my man. I was hoping you would help me speak to him... or tell me... tell me what you know about it.

MRS ADEBOWALE

(chuckles)

Listen, whatever you heard or being told is true. Also, I do not owe you any explanation because you can't handle the truth. I need a strong woman for my son, not a weakling like you...

Stella tingles her fingers, frustrated. She looks at Mrs Adebowale and forces a smile.

STELLA

(stutters)

My intentions... towards your son is pure, very pure. I don't know you have decided to pick fault in me but all the same... I will grant your request and find my own man.

She chuckles bitterly and walks out -- Mrs Adebowale hisses, annoyed.

MRS ADEBOWALE

Radarada...

22 INT. STELLA'S CAR - LATER

22

With force, Stella bangs the steering repeatedly, crying and screaming.

STELLA

W-h-y-y-y-y-y-y? What have I done to deserve such treatment? Am I good enough?

She yells and flings her WIG away.

STELLA (cont'd)

Am I not? Why do you have to do this to me?... Richard... why?

She sobs as she rests her head on the steering.

23 INT. RICHARD'S HOUSE - BEDROOM - AN HOUR LATER

23

Door bangs open, Stella storms in, furrowed eyes, restless. She walks straight to the wardrobe -- Richard rushes in, panting and pleading.

RICHARD

Babe! Please, you don't have to do this...

Stella yanks the wardrobe door open -- She fetch out some clothes from different corners of the wardrobe. Richard grabs his head, pacing. He sees the door and snaps his fingers, more like a realization. He shuts the door and puts the key in his pocket.

Stella looks back and sees his moves -- She chuckles hysterically and yell, angry.

STELLA

Richard!

Richard flinches as he stays very close to the door, rubbing his palms together, pleading.

STELLA (cont'd)

Don't. Mess. With. Me! Open that door.

RICHARD

(stutters)

I can't... I can't let you go. Where do you want to go to?

Stella hisses and brings out a traveling bag. She drops on the bed, unzips it and start putting her clothes in.

STELLA

Or let me remind you, I have my house. I am leaving you and everything that relates to you...

RICHARD

(frustrated)

Why?

Stella yells, furious.

STELLA

Because my mental health doesn't matter to you !

She burst into tears, crying.

STELLA (cont'd)

I have tried. I have pleaded to you severally but you chose to keep the truth away from me, after revealing all of my past to you...

(MORE)

STELLA (cont'd)
Literally, you know everything in my
life, down to my menstrual cycle but
h-e-y-y-y! I must leave you alone
because your past hurts, right? I
will leave you. I. Will. Leave.
You...

She forces the rest of the clothe into the bag -- Richard
exhales as tears rolls down his face. Stella zips up the bag
and drop it on the floor.

STELLA (cont'd)
Live your life the way you want it. I
cannot deal anymore.

She strides towards the door, with the bag in her hand.

STELLA (cont'd)
Open this door!

Richard stands in her way, blocking her from getting to the
door.

STELLA (cont'd)
(chuckles)
Richard... or whatever is your name.
Don't make me do something I will
regret...

RICHARD
I don't mind, babe. I will do
anything to keep you here.

Stella drops the bag, with furrowed eyes -- She grabs
Richard's shirt by the neck.

RICHARD (cont'd)
If this is going to make you stay,
I'm in.

STELLA
Open... open this door, now!

Stella yells again and burst into tears.

STELLA (cont'd)
Open this door!

RICHARD
I can't...

Stella begins to beat Richard on his chest, crying.

RICHARD (cont'd)
Babe... babe... babe... listen, I
don't know what you have heard from
that lady but I can assure you that
it is all a lie...

STELLA
Wow! A liar! That is what you are...

RICHARD
Believe me or not, I know that
lady...

Stella's jaw drops, shocked.

RICHARD (cont'd)
Yes. It all started in Uni.

24 INT. RICHARD'S ROOM -- FEW YEARS BACK.

24

The setting depicts a student room.

Young Richard (25) and ELLA (24) bant each other as they
play Ludo. From the look of the game, Ella seems to be
winning and stylishly rubbing it on Richard's face.

The bant is subtle and fun until the door breaks open...

ELLA
(shocked)
Jesus!

Ella and Rachael almost hit each other at the sight of three
muscular men, fierce and fearless. They walk in,
majestically and laughing hysterically. Richard, on his
kneels, rubbing his palms together, pleading. Ella whimpers
at Richard's back, pleading. Man 1 sits on the chair close
to the bed. Man 2 stands close to Man 1. Man 3 guards the
door, with machete in his hand.

MAN 1
(chuckles)
Be like say na the girl be this...

Ella's eyes widens, shocked. Richard fidgets, scared. Man 2
glares at Ella -- He smirks and nods, confirming her...

MAN 2
Na she.

MAN 3
Straight to business. Hey bobo!

Richard swallows hard, terrified.

RICHARD
(stutters)
Sir... what.. I am...

MAN 1
We no come here con waste your time
and no be even you we con face. Na
that kele wey dey your back.

Richard lock hands with Ella, both panting.

ELLA
I am sorry sir. I don't know... what
did I do?

The three men laugh.

MAN 2
(laughs)
You don pass your boundary and we wan
teach you small lesson.

Ella whimpers aloud, sweating and crying.

MAN 3
Time no dey abeg. Make we do wetin we
go do. Sharp!

RICHARD
(stutters)
Sir. What did we do?

Man 1 slaps Richard -- Ella recoils with a yell, as if she wants to enter the wall. Richard sobs as he rubs his cheeks.

MAN 1
Make una lock that door.

Man 3 checks the door again to confirm. Man 1 stands up and slowly approaches Ella -- Ella begins to screams as he nears her. She begins to plead with a shaky voice.

ELLA
Please please sir...

MAN 1
Na that guy wey you abuse for
department say make we con teach you
lesson.

MAN 1 faces Richard, who is back on his knees pleading.

MAN 1 (cont'd)
(to Richard)
We wan check your babe out.

BEAT -- (INAUDIBLY) THE THREE MEN TAKE TURNS ON ELLA.

Richard watches in total dismay as he blocks his ears and cries bitterly. Ella sobs, almost out of breathe.

BEAT -- The three men watch Richard, intently and make gest of him as he makes love to Ella in pool of blood.

RICHARD V.O
One of the men laid the machete on me as I tried fighting them. That was what infuriated them and I was forced to have sex with Ella. Hence the mark on my shoulder. Things went south almost immediately when Ella began to gag... gag and gag. Silence ensues among the four of us as we watch Ella take her last breath.

BEAT -- The three men storm out of the room.

RICHARD V.O (cont'd)
It felt the walls of my life were closing in on me. I felt the cold that someone dear to me had just left. I... became numb and sat there with her, helpless and hopeless. In few minutes, I was in pool of tears, begging and begging Ella to come back to life. As expected, nobody believed that I did not kill her, not even Teniola, who happens to be her sister. She was really instrumental in getting me ruined by the incidence. Thank God for my Mum, who stepped in and made sure I didn't spend my years in prison. It was a case of rape to murder.

Richard sighs.

RICHARD V.O (cont'd)
Now, you understand why she is so bitter and ready to bring me down. She tried all she could but to no avail. I think she is just trying to take revenge.

CUT BACK

25 INT. RICHARD'S HOUSE - BEDROOM - END OF FLASHBACK

25

Richard sits on the floor, eyes swollen and weak. Stella perches on the bed, covering her mouth as she sobs.

STELLA

Oh my God!

RICHARD

It has not been the same since then.
I try to forget it but I can't and
that is why I refused to speak about
it to you.

STELLA

(cries out)

She told me a different story
entirely.

Richard groans as he tries to move close to Stella.

RICHARD

Now you see that she is just
bitter...

Stella sniffles and wipe her face.

STELLA

See... I don't know which version of
the story to believe. I have to
leave.

RICHARD

Babe... you...

Stella cuts in, still sobbing.

STELLA

I need some time alone. These... all
these is too much for me to handle. I
can't think if I am still around you.

RICHARD

(swallows hard)

Fine... I understand. You will be
back, right?

STELLA

Let me have the key, please.

Richard brings out the key and hands it to -- Stella grabs her bag.

RICHARD
I need you, Stella. I really do need
you. It's been hell of a life for me.
What would become of me if you leave?

Stella grunts her as she hold the bag -- She breathes
shakily as she approaches the door and open it.

RICHARD (cont'd)
Babe... don't leave me.

Stella looks back at him, with damp eyes and nods, tearful.

STELLA
I have to go... bye.

She steps out of the room and closes the door -- Richard
cries out as he falls onto the bed.

26 INT. STELLA'S BEDROOM - MIDNIGHT

26

Stella sobs into her bedroom, staggering towards her bed
area -- Her bed is filled with twisted tissues, including
the floor.

She breathe heavily as she perches on the bed -- The tissue
in her hand falls.

Her phone rings repeatedly but she ignores as she sobs
louder. She falls to her side, still crying.

27 INT. RICHARD'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - DAY

27

A filthy space, filled with empty beer bottles and takeout.
Richard, now a mess and shadow of himself. He sits on the
floor, speaking gibberish as he gulps down a bottle of
alcohol.

Tears rolls down his cheeks, sobbing. Few minutes later, his
phone rings -- He rushes to it and hisses at the sight of
the screen.

The caller is "Mum" -- He goes back to drinking.

28 INT. STELLA'S HOUSE - DINNER - FEW DAYS LATER

28

Stella grabs the knife beside the plate (filled with apples)
and picks one of the apple.

She motions to start cutting it -- Her phone rings. She
checks the screen and sees "Babe"

She drops the the apple and knife -- Her shoulder falls to her side, tired.

She sighs and accepts the call.

RICHARD V.O
(stutters)
Babe... hey.. hey! Just listen to me
please...

Stella watches the screen, silent and uninterested.

RICHARD V.O (cont'd)
I am so sorry. Please, forgive me.

Stella clenches her fist, restless.

RICHARD V.O (cont'd)
Talk to me, please...

Stella bites her lips and cut the call and turn off her phone. She gets up and walk away, restless.

29 INT. RICHARD'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - DAY

29

The whole house is cleaned up now. Richard slouches on the couch, silent and staring blankly. Mrs Adebowale, stares at him and shakes his head.

MRS ADEBOWALE
Son. What is this you are doing to
me?

Richard chuckles softly.

MRS ADEBOWALE (cont'd)
Why are you attaching so much
importance to that lifeless lady?
Have you forgotten the son of whom
you are? Stop being a weakling and
stand up for yourself! She doesn't
deserve you in any way...

RICHARD
Neither do I deserve you.

Mrs Adebowale stares intently at him, confused. Richard sits up, looking at his mother.

RICHARD (cont'd)
I do not deserve a mother like you.
You haven't brought me any happiness
in recent years.

MRS ADEBOWALE
(furious)
What do you mean?

RICHARD
I have been living my life in total darkness. I finally found the light but the woman who birthed me have refused to support my choice for once. She is gone now. Are you not happy?

Mrs Adebowale stutters, guilty.

RICHARD (cont'd)
I can see you derive so much pleasure in my pains. Whatever you do, Mother; remember the Lord is watching you. Lock my doors when you leave. Bye.

Mrs Adebowale sits back, all to herself as she bows her head, embarrassed. Richard storms in.

INTER CUT

30 INT. ELIZA'S LIVING ROOM - SAME TIME

30

Stella perches on the couch, face covered with her palms, sobbing. **ELIZA (F. 38)** runs her arms across Stella's shoulder as she speaks.

ELIZA
My dear. I feel your pain. I have been there. The chase, the thrills and the roller coaster of emotions you feel when you are in love is not from here.

STELLA
(weeping)
He lied to me! He lied!

ELIZA
Yes. He did... because he is human and prone to do what humans do mostly, which is mistake. He has his fault for not revealing his past to you but what exactly do you want to do?

Stella sniffles and wipes her face. They lock gazes.

STELLA

(teary)

I have no idea, sis. I don't know...

ELIZA

Richard loves you, so dearly. I can tell you for a fact that he was only scared of losing you. So, what if he has a dark past? We all have secrets and now that you know, the decision is in your hands. Do you want to forgive him and look past his flaws or hold it against him?

Stella sighs, unsure.

ELIZA (cont'd)

Mind you, you can only hold it against him if you are a saint.

STELLA

But...

ELIZA

No buts, my dear. Life is all about tolerance. Be his happiness, not his weak point. Think thoroughly and act right, okay?

Stella nods in agreement, relieved.

STELLA

Thank you, sis. I am really grateful.

They hug -- Stella's phone rings. She checks the screen, with furrowed eyes. She sees the caller "TENIOLA"

ELIZA

Who is that?

STELLA

Sis. This is the lady we met at the grocery store. The one who took our pictures.

ELIZA

Wow! do you want to pick it?

Stella chuckle softly and nods, agreeing to pick. She picks the call as they both pay attention to Teniola's voice.

TENIOLA

(enthusiastic)

Sis! Hello...

STELLA

Hey.

TENIOLA

Oh my God! Is everything alright with you? You sound off.

STELLA

Sure. I am okay.

TENIOLA

Great! It's been a while. What's going on with you? I have really missed your vibe...

STELLA

(confused)

My vibe? Me?

TENIOLA

Yes! You know... I have been thinking, maybe we can have dinner together one of these days.

STELLA

(firm)

Thank you, but I will pass...

Teniola sighs.

TENIOLA V.O

Does this have to do with that miserable fellow? Listen to me, I am the best person you can count on for support right now. I know for a fact that you are hurting right now but please, give me a chance to show you around to quality men that will take care of you. The likes of...

Stella cuts in.

STELLA

Again, I will pass.

TENIOLA V.O

Hey hey hey! What is the mater with you? I care about you, that is why I'm after your well-being. Have you not confronted him yet?

Stella looks at Eliza -- Eliza nods.

STELLA

I have.

TENIOLA V.O

Very good. I am sure he lied again. That, right there is the reason why you should let go off him and move on with your life. He doesn't deserve you.

STELLA

See... I don't know yet. Thank you for reaching out but...

Teniola cuts in.

TENIOLA V.O

But what? This is the best I can go, young lady.

Stella and Eliza are stunned.

TENIOLA V.O (cont'd)

That man is evil. He will kill you, cut your shimmering flesh into pieces and eat them. Listen to me! I am still hurting from the trauma and pain of losing my sister because of that bastard. I am going to bring him down if you fail to dance to my tune.

STELLA

(shocked)

Dance to your tune? Why?

TENIOLA V.O

(yells)

Because he is evil! Are you daft? Are you not supposed to support me in bringing this man down?

Eliza shakes her head, disagreeing. Stella swallows hard, restless.

STELLA

I don't know...

Eliza grabs the phone from Stella.

ELIZA

Whatever your name is, young lady; save yourself this stress and back off.

Teniola laughs hysterical.

TENIOLA V.O

(firm)

Very good. You both will hear from me. Nuisance.

The call drops -- Stella stares at Eliza, helpless and restless. Eliza rubs her chest down, gesturing to her to calm down.

ELIZA

All will be taken care of. If she wants trouble, we will garnish some for her.

Stella nods rapidly, trying to comfort herself.

31 INT. STELLA'S BEDROOM - THE NEXT DAY

31

Stella, in bed with her arms crossed, bothered and brooding.

STELLA V.O

Stella. Do you really want to let go or fight for what you love?

She sighs deeply.

STELLA V.O (cont'd)

I can't deny my love for this man... I really can't. Two years down the drain?

She furrows her eyes as she snaps her finger over her head, rejecting the thought.

STELLA V.O (cont'd)

I can't allow that... something must be done before things get out of hand...

She picks up her phone, hesitating to press it or not. She gets off her bed and walk to her wardrobe.

32 INT. RICHARD'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - AN HOUR LATER

32

Richard slouches, watching TV. He watches with no single expression or emotion on his face.

Few seconds later, knocks on the door. He responds without looking at it.

RICHARD
It's opened.

Door squeaks open, Stella enters, with a medium sized bag in her hand. Richard snuffles while his gaze is on the T.V, as if he smelt something. In split seconds, he looks at the door and jump off the chair, excited and shocked.

RICHARD (cont'd)
Jesus! Babe...

He rushes to her -- they hug. Stella forces a smile. Richard pants, restless.

RICHARD (cont'd)
I am so sorry please. Forgive me. Ah!
Thank you, Jesus.

STELLA
(clears her throat)
Why God?

Richard giggles.

RICHARD
You will not understand. Let me help
you with your bag.

Stella blushes but tries to keep a straight face as Richard collects her bag.

RICHARD (cont'd)
After you, my love.

Stella rolls her eyes, teasingly. She obliges.

RICHARD (cont'd)
(yells)
She is back!

BEAT : RICHARD SITS UP AS THEY CONVERSE. STELLA SITS BACK ON THE COUCH - RELAXED.

STELLA
I thought about what we have had...
it has been beautiful. Am I angry?
Yes. Have I forgiven? Yes...

Richard throws a fist up, happy.

RICHARD
But not completely.

Richard composes himself.

STELLA
I am still angry...

RICHARD
(stutters)
But you are back... why?

STELLA
Because I love you and I don't want
to lose you. Fine. It's your past and
so what? Nobody is a saint.

RICHARD
(low tone)
That is... fair. I am genuinely sorry
and happy to have you back.

Silence lingers for few seconds. Richard stares at her
handbag, disappointed.

RICHARD (cont'd)
This bag... isn't it too small?

STELLA
We have more pressing issues to deal
with...

Richard sits up, enthusiastic.

STELLA (cont'd)
We must find a way curb whatever
thing tried to break us and as for
your Mum... I really don't know.

RICHARD
My Mum... She isn't really a tough
meat. I will handle her. Just tell me
what you want me to do...

STELLA
(sigh)
Richard. Are you ready to let go off
your past and build a future with me?

33 INT. RICHARD'S HOUSE - BEDROOM - NIGHT

33

The room is dimly lit. Stella and Richard walk into the
frame from opposite direction, smiling. They hold hands as
they stare intently into each others eyes, a spark of new
beginning.

RICHARD

I pledge allegiance to let go off my
past and make you the happiest man on
earth.

STELLA

(subtle)

I missed you.

RICHARD

I missed you too.

They kiss and fall into the bed.

34 **EXT. BEACH - DAY**

34

Richard, dressed in beach wear, shirt slightly unbuttoned and sun glasses on his face hold Stella, dressed in beach wear, sunshade on her face, as **they stride along the edge of the beach, conversing inaudibly.**

Few minutes later, Richard, now shirtless; **make ridges with his legs** -- Stella tiptoes towards him and kicks the ridges -- **She begins to run.** Richard runs after and catches up with her. He holds her by the waist and **they kiss.**

They run around the edges of the beach, playing with the water.

Few minutes later, Stella poses as Richard takes her pictures from different.

BEAT : They clinks their cocktail drinks and take some **selfies.**

35 **INT. TENIOLA'S HOUSE - SITTING ROOM - DAY**

35

Teniola fumes as she goes through her phone. She scrolls on Instagram, viewing Stella's story.

She chuckles, clenching her fist and gnashing her teeth, angry. She finally drops the phone and suddenly yells.

TENIOLA

(loud)

Teni! Pattern up. These people are
messing with me.

She picks up the phone and stares intently at it. She nods, ready to take an action.

36 INT. RICHARD'S HOUSE - KITCHEN - SAME TIME

36

Stella, wears apron as she cooks in the kitchen. Minutes later Richard tiptoes into the kitchen. He tickles Stella, playfully.

Inaudibly, she startles -- Richard laughs at her. They play around the kitchen.

Stella offers Richard to taste the food for her.

RICHARD

Hmm... this is way too tasty and sweet. The sweetness of this food is only surpassed by the cook.

STELLA

Hmm... My man is back. See l-i-n-e-s-s-s-s-s!

RICHARD

I guess we are both cooking.

Richard winks at her. They hug. Stella's phone rings -- They disengage. She checks the screen and sees the caller "Teniola"

STELLA

(to richard)

Babe, see.

She shows Richard her screen.

RICHARD

Pick it and put it on speaker.

Stella obliges.

STELLA

Hello! What'd you want?

TENIOLA

Hello. Please listen to me. I have a new information about him.

STELLA

Who?

TENIOLA

Your man. Apparently, it is darker than I thought. We need to see.

Stella looks at Richard -- Richard nods, agreeing.

STELLA
Fine. Where?

TENIOLA
Pick a venue.

STELLA
B Lounge by 4pm.

TENIOLA
Thank you so much.

Stella drops the call.

STELLA
She has to be dealt with, babe.

RICHARD
I will handle it.

37 **EXT. LOUNGE - LATER**

37

Stella watches Teniola sipping her drinks, elegantly.

STELLA
Thought you brought me here for
something important?

Teniola chuckles and drops her drink on the table. She
crosses her legs and clasps her hands, stylishly.

TENIOLA
You brought me here but hey, it
doesn't matter...

Stella chuckles bitterly and checks her phone.

STELLA
I have a lot on my plate. What is it
that I need to know?

TENIOLA
That your man is a cheat and a
murderer.

STELLA
You already said it, with no proof.
Anything else?

Teniola sits up, angry.

TENIOLA

What is wrong with you? Are you so daft? Do you think I am going to let go just like that?

STELLA

I will advice you to let go.

TENIOLA

I won't and if you are not careful, I will make you pay for the sins you never committed.

Stella chuckles and sits back, relaxed.

STELLA

How do you intend to do that?

TENIOLA

Are you trying to test my intelligence?

Richard and three policemen approach.

RICHARD

Yes. We are.

Teniola flinches on her chair at the sight of Richard and the police.

TENIOLA

(stutters)

What is... going on here? I called her, not you.

RICHARD

She is mine and I'm hers. So, time up.

Teniola stands up, restless and angry.

TENIOLA

No... no... I won't take that. Why are you with the police?

RICHARD

You have been causing me so much trouble and now, I really want to help you. Whatever evidence or proof you have, please go with police and show it to them.

Stella chuckles and sips her drink.

TENIOLA
(shocked)
That can't be right.

RICHARD
(to the police)
Here she is. Do your job please.

Police man 1 moves forward.

POLICE MAN 1
Madam. Do your best and cooperate
with us. We need your presence in our
station.

TENIOLA
(yells)
For what? for what o?

POLICE MAN 1
When you get to our station, you will
understand better.

The two other police men grabs Teniola as she begins to cry
out. They take her away -- Richard and Stella hugs.

RICHARD
Love lives here now.

STELLA
That's right.

They kiss.

FADE TO BLACK

